Christine

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/56177176.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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5+1 Things, Pining, like so much pining you have no idea, like this entire fic is pining, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Alternate Universe - 2000s, comphet, minor adora/kyle, points to the comphet tag, Human Catra (She-Ra), Implied/Referenced Homophobia, Minor Angst, Not Beta Read

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Part 2 of Home Video: An Anthology

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by gloommistress

Summary

You're mumbling in your sleep, barely distinguishable words and half-phrases. I swear I hear my name once or twice. That warms my heart, to know that I occupy your dreams just as you occupy mine. Even if it's not in the same way.

I clutch your hand in my palm, running my thumb across your knuckles. Up front Kyle finally settles on a radio station, some pop hit playing that I don't know, but you would sing along with in a heartbeat.

Kyle catches a glimpse of you slumbering through the rearview mirror, and a smile alights on his face. I have to strain to keep mine from scowling in response. It isn't his fault I'll never have you the way I want you.

***

Or, five times Catra wished for the unattainable, and one time her wish came true.

Inspired by Christine by Lucy Dacus

1. **July 17, 2006**

You're falling asleep, your head slumped on my shoulder as the pickup truck rumbles around us. Your boyfriend is in the front seat, absently flicking through the radio, paying us no mind.

We're on our way home from Sunday church, from yet another sermon illustrating our need for repentance. One might think there might be a limit to the righteous guilt one could possess, but Pastor Prime seems to think otherwise. His words this week were all fire and brimstone, damning those like me to an eternity of suffering. I tried to ignore him. Just like I tried to ignore you sitting next to me, listening intently. I wonder if you knew, then would you still hang onto every word.

You're mumbling in your sleep, barely distinguishable words and half-phrases. I swear I hear my name once or twice. That warms my heart, to know that I occupy your dreams just as you occupy mine. Even if it's not in the same way.

I clutch your hand in my palm, running my thumb across your knuckles. Up front Kyle finally settles on a radio station, some pop hit playing that I don't know, but you would sing along with in a heartbeat.

Kyle catches a glimpse of you slumbering through the rearview mirror, and a smile alights on his face. I have to strain to keep mine from scowling in response. It isn't his fault I'll never have you the way I want you.

I attempt to remind myself of how excited you were when he asked you out. Of how you smile when he holds your hand, or how you laugh at his terrible puns. I don't know what it says about me, that the more at ease you are with him, the more my disdain grows. What's worse is that despite my callous coldness,

my distant disregard, is that he is always nice to me. I think that makes me hate him more.

It's not really him I hate, though. Moreso the idea of him. The notion of anyone who isn't me being able to touch you, to hold you. Even if it never means what I want it to mean, my heart still flutters every time you embrace me in a hug, or hold my hand in class. It pains me to see you act the same with him, only he gets to have what I never could. I'm not sure how I'd react if I saw you kiss him.

Kyle turns his truck onto my street, and soon is pulling up in front of Weaver's house. She isn't home yet, most likely still socializing with her church friends. I shake you awake, so I can pull you into a hug before I leave. You half mumble a farewell, still lethargic from sleep.

As I walk up the driveway, I turn to see Kyle waving goodbye at me. I don't wave back.

2. **December 25, 2006**

"Do you ever think about kids?" You ask, watching your younger cousins rush around the house, playing some nonsensical game. It's become a tradition for me to join your family for Christmas. It's not like my mother would miss me, after all.

"No, kids are the worst." I instinctively reply, a lie readied on my tongue. Because I have thought about it. About nurturing a life, watching them grow. I don't think I'd be a very good parent, but you would be. And for all I daydream of a family I could call my own, the one consistent piece of the puzzle is you. Without you it all falls apart.

"Oh," you reply, face fallen.

I take pity and nudge your shoulder with my own, "Do you?"

"Yeah, someday," You say, a wistful expression on your face.

"With Kyle?" I can't help but ask.

A complicated series of emotions pass over you, before you say, "Maybe."

My traitorous insides roil in hope. I stamp them down just as fervently. "What, is Kyle not hubby material?" I snark.

You sigh, bringing your knees to your chest, wrapping your arms around them, "I don't know. I just don't think I feel the way I'm supposed to, with him."

I didn't really know what to say to that. I've never been good at being comforting. Thankfully, you save me from responding, "Wanna get out of here?"

I look at you in bewilderment, "Sneak out before presents? Who are you and what have you done with Adora?"

"I meant go to my room." You clarify.

I stand, mock bow, and say, "Lead the way."

When the door shuts behind us I collapse onto your bed, while you begin to rummage through your dresser.

"Waddya looking for?" I ask, curious.

"I got you something. Ah! Here it is." You pull out a small gift wrapped present from the bottom drawer, and thrust it towards me.

Without further ado, I tear into the present, revealing a multi-threaded gold and red bracelet.

"Merry Christmas, Catra." You say with a beaming smile, holding up your wrist up to show an identical one.

"Friendship bracelets?" I deadpan, in surprise.

"Do you--, do you not like it?" You look hurt by the very notion.

"No, Princess, I love it, I just--, why? We aren't kids anymore."

"I know that, it's just--, we're halfway through high school, and then we'll be going off to college, and--, and I don't want you to forget about me, or for us to ever stop being friends." You ramble out.

"Oh, Adora," I take your hands in mine, squeezing comfortingly, "I'm never going to forget about you, and as far as I'm concerned, you're stuck with me forever."

You alit into a beaming smile, "Promise?"

"I promise, Princess. Now stay here, I have something for you too."

I quickly run downstairs and grab my present from where I had placed it under the tree. You're exactly where I left you, primly seated on the edge of your bed. With the early morning light streaming through the window illuminating your golden hair, you look like an angel.

I have to snap myself out of staring, frozen in the doorway. I haltingly hold out the gift bag for you to take.

When you open it, an impossibly soft expression comes over you, "This is for me?"

I nod. In your hands is a golden wing pendant, hung on a golden chain. You excitedly attach it around your neck, and say, "I love it."

"That promise goes both ways, you know." I say, returning to our previous conversation. "Don't you ever forget about me. Promise it."

You look temporarily taken aback by the insistency, before your expression morphs into one of determinedness.

"I promise." You vow.

And I foolishly believe you.

3. **February 9, 2007**

We're lying in your bed, having stalled out on working on our homework. I'm lost in thought, and I almost don't notice you fidgeting nervously next to me.

"I broke up with Kyle." You say, apropos of nothing.

"What, why?" I have to fight to keep from smiling. God how awful of a person does one have to be, for that to be their reaction.

"It's fine, I know you never liked him."

"That's not true," I protested, an outright lie. You look doubtfully at me in response, not buying it. "Okay fine I never liked him, but I still don't want to see you sad."

"I'm not sad," You protest. I don't buy it. "Really! Like I said, I broke up with him."

I turn my head to look at you fully. Our faces are inches away. For a fleeting moment, I imagine surging forward and capturing your lips with my own. I immediately banish the thought. "Why'd you do that?"

You shrug, as much as you can, lying on one side, "I dunno. I just did."

"Hmm," I say eloquently, before settling on, "Good."

You scrunch your eyebrows, "Good?"

"You deserve better than Kyle." I state definitively.

"What about you?"

"What about me, what?"

"Who are you interested in dating?"

I freeze. Do you know? Did you somehow find out? What was this? I school my features and scoff, "No one."

"That can't be true. There has to be someone?" You insist. I wish you would just drop it.

Uncertain of how to proceed, I instead spend the next minute in increasingly panicked silence.

You reach out and take my hand in your own. "Hey, you know you can tell me anything, right?"

"Adora, I'm--," I take a deep breath before it comes spilling out, "I'm gay."

You look dumbstruck, "Oh."

"Oh?" I respond tentatively.

You recover from your surprise, and a devious smirk crosses your face, "So who are you interested in then? Lonnie? Octavia?"

"Wait, hold up. You're not disgusted? You're not going to tell me to pray the gay away? Or any other bullshit?"

You shrug again, "You're my best friend. If you're gay, then it can't be bad."

"I, uh, thank you?" I stammer in astonishment. Never in my wildest dreams did I consider this a possible outcome.

That mischievous smile reappears, "You never answered my previous question."

"Ugh, and I'm not going to. Get over yourself." I shove a pillow into your face, and just like that, we're bantering just like we always do. As if nothing’s changed, as if I hadn't just bared my soul and been met with nothing but grace and acceptance. As if everything hadn't monumentally shifted.

Against every ounce of self-preservation, I allow a small flicker of hope to ember inside my chest.

4. **April 4, 2008**

"And that one's Aquarius," You say. I follow your finger to where you're pointing, and roll my eyes.

"No, dummy, I'm pretty sure that one’s Andromeda."

You scrunch your brow adorably, and look down to the book of constellations you rented from the library. "Oh, you're right."

"Of course I'm right." I sass.

"You don't have to rub it in," You pout, causing me to laugh.

"Don't I?"

We're sitting atop the roof outside my room's window. Thankfully Weaver isn't home, else I would never risk being caught up here. The stars are out full force tonight, not a cloud in sight, the milky way stretching across the sky.

I turn to you and you're looking at me with a heartsick forlorn expression.

"I'm going to miss you." You admit, and my heart swells.

I hadn't allowed myself to consider the reality of it until now. Against my better nature, tears begin to well in my eyes. I desperately wipe them away and choke out, "I'm going to miss you too, or whatever."

You wrap me in your arms, and I rest my head on your shoulder. After sniffling a few times, I manage to get out, "Besides, this isn't the end. We have phones, you know. And we'll see each other when we're home for the holidays." I reassure, though it feels like I'm comforting myself more than I am you.

You sigh, "God, why did we choose colleges so far away again?"

It broke my heart, when you announced you had gotten into Brightmoon, your top choice. I acted happy for you, of course I did. But that didn't stop me from internally mourning a dream that had no hope of ever becoming reality. We were supposed to conquer the world together. Instead now we're going to be two thousand miles apart.

Tonight's the last night before you fly out. To celebrate, or mourn, we snuck a bottle of vodka from my mom's stash, and got some lemonade to mix it with. By the time we made it to the roof, it was 3 am and we were both solidly buzzed. At least I am, I'm assuming you are too.

"Do you remember our promise?" I ask, letting the words drift out into the night sky.

You look taken aback, "Of course I do."

"Promise again. That we won't forget each other."

You smile earnestly, "I promise. We'll always be friends, Catra. We're not going to let a little distance stop us."

There, cast in the moonlight, you look angelic, holy. From my point of view your face is framed against the swirlings of stars above, looking down at me like a goddess deigning to grace a lowly mortal with her presence. You bring your hand up to rest on

my cheek, your thumb gently stroking my cheekbone, and my breath catches in my throat.

I don't even notice myself doing it. I don't register tilting my head up, and surging forward. I don't comprehend it until my lips are on yours, and it feels like everything I've ever wanted come alive.

"Mrrp!" You squeak, and I'm shocked out of the moment. I rush to back away, and end up tripping over myself and falling on my ass on the roof.

Your jaw is hinging up and down soundlessly, before you stammer, "I--, uh--, we should go back inside."

Silently I nod, suddenly paralyzed by fear. I snap myself out of it enough to follow you back through the window. Once we're in my room, you make up a shitty excuse, that it's late, and you need to be up early for your flight. I distantly offer to walk you out, but you decline. And I am left sitting on my bed, straining to hear the front door open and close as you flee.

As soon as I'm sure you're gone, I burst into tears.

5. **October 31, 2012**

It's been four years since I've seen you, since I've talked to you. After the first year of missed calls and convoluted excuses I gave up trying. There's only so much heartbreak one can take before they shatter completely, after all.

That first year was the worst. The longer I went without hearing from you, the longer it went with you ignoring my texts, the more untethered I became. It eventually came to a head when I broke down in a lecture. After that, Scorpia convinced me to give therapy a try. I'm reluctant to admit that it was a good decision.

Netossa has helped me see that all of this shit was not my fault. It's not because I wasn't good enough, or because I ruin things, or even because I kissed you. It's not my fault I fell for the straightest girl on the planet. You're the one who cut things off, you're the one who ran away. You're the one who broke the promise.

She's also the one who convinced me to start writing these journals, reflecting on everything that happened between us, the good and the bad. Categorizing and documenting memories, that sort of thing. This will be my last entry, as we've finally reached the end of the story. There's only a few threads left to unravel.

Despite what you did, college itself hasn't been all that bad. Freighton Tech ended up being a good choice for my major, and I've made a scant few close friends. Not as close as we were though. I doubt I'll ever let myself be that close with anyone ever again.

It's time for me to close the door on that chapter of my life. It's time for me to stop mourning a relationship that clearly didn't mean as much to you as it did for me.

It's time for me to be the one to leave you behind for once.

Scorpia's new girlfriend is hosting a party tonight. I think I'm going to go. Apparently it isn't helpful for me to shut myself indoors all the time, only focusing on schoolwork.

I'm going to go, and I'm going to have fun, and nothing's going to stop me. I'm finally going to forget about you.

Just like you forgot about me.

+1

Catra scanned around her surroundings. Perfuma's halloween party was in an expansive house, far larger in scale than the suburban two stories Catra had grown up in. She had passed a sizable pool outside, and the interior was decorated with a plethora of houseplants, lining every wall and corner. Catra passed through a number of rooms before she found what she was looking for: a fully stocked bar.

She pulled a bottle of whiskey off of the bartop and poured herself an old fashioned with the ease of someone who had been bartending for years. Her part time job paid well, and her takes-no-shit attitude had proven to be a boon in it, rather than a hindrance.

With her drink made, she extricated herself from behind the bar before anyone could ambush her with drink orders, and set off to find either Scorpia or Entrapta.

They had worn matching costumes this year, all from some superhero movie Catra hadn't bothered to see. She had to admit though, the black clad spy costume she had been told to wear was pretty badass.

After several minutes of fruitless searching Catra silently cursed to herself. How hard could it be to find someone who was literally covered in green body paint? Or Entrapta, whose costume literally glowed?

"Catra! There you are!" A voice called from down the hall, and Catra turned to see Perfuma striding towards her in a genderbent Captain America costume. "Scorpia's been looking for you, they want to take photos!"

"Your house is a maze," Catra replied sardonically, following when Perfuma began leading her outside.

As soon as they stepped outside the screen door to the backyard, Catra was wrapped up in a crushing hug, "Wildcat!"

"Bodypaint, Scorp!"

Scorpia set her back down, and sheepishly apologized, "Sorry, sorry! We found people to take photos with though! Now we have the complete team!"

Scorpia moved aside, and Catra's entire body went rigid, as heterochromatic eyes met blue. Standing there, next to a bow and arrow wielding boy was none other than Adora Grayskull, clad in a Thor outfit that left little about her biceps to the imagination. Catra hated that her first thought upon seeing her former friend again was admiring her new stature.

Adora looked just as shocked as Catra, and didn't resist as they were bundled together into a photo with the whole group. Catra could only struggle to keep composure as everyone else posed around them, and the camera flashed several times, causing her to wince.

When everyone parted, Perfuma made introductions, unaware of the internal meltdown Catra was undergoing, "Catra, this is Adora and Bow, two of my friends from Brightmoon."

"We know each other." Catra gritted out, barely able to restrain her anger.

Adora was looking at her with a look Catra couldn't decipher. Whatever it was, it wasn't good. When Adora didn't say anything, just stared on soundlessly, Catra scoffed and turned to storm off.

"Catra wait!" Adora lunged forward and grabbed Catra by the wrist.

She froze, before wrenching her arm away. "Don't touch me!" She snarled.

"I'm sorry, I just want to talk!" Adora pleaded to deaf ears.

Catra laughed darkly, "Oh, now you want to talk?"

Catra strode towards Adora confidently, and got up in her face, "Fuck you, Adora." She spat, and then shoved Adora into the pool

behind her.

Adora impacted the water with a colossal splash, kicking and thrashing, and Catra couldn't help but crack a smile of karmic justice at the sight. Finally, Adora surfaced, treading water. Satisfied, Catra turned to leave with her head held high.

"I'm Gay!" Adora shouted just as she began walking away. Catra froze in her tracks. To say she hadn't been expecting that declaration would be a vast understatement.

"I had a meltdown about it, freshman year. That's why I stopped talking to you. I know it was shitty, and I'm so sorry. I never meant for it to be forever, but then you sent me all those texts saying you hated me, and I couldn't bring myself to find the courage to break the silence. I'm sorry, I really am. Please, just don't go." The words spilled out of Adora like she would never have the chance to speak to Catra again.

Catra stood there unreactive, processing this new information, as Adora swam to the ladder and climbed out of the pool. She advanced Catra slowly, as if she were a feral animal ready to flee.

"Please, I know I fucked up, I just want to make it up to you."

"Fine." Catra grunted out, now suddenly viscerally aware of the small crowd gathered around them spectating. She grabbed Adora by the wrist and began dragging her into the house. Adora happily complied, dripping water in her wake.

Catra was able to find an empty spare bedroom where they would have some privacy without issue. She quickly raided the closet for some towels, throwing them at Adora to dry off, before crossing her arms and demanding, "Explain."

Adora sighed, and sat on the edge of the bed, "I didn't realize, until that kiss. That's why I ran, cause I didn't know what I was feeling. It was all just too much. And then I made the mistake of telling my parents I thought I might be gay a few weeks later, and they took it really poorly. So I just threw myself into school. And

before I knew it, it had been months since I'd called you. And I wanted to reach out again, but I just never knew what to say."

Catra began pacing, "You could have just told me! I didn't deserve to be shut out like that! We could have handled it together! Why the hell wouldn't you just send me a text explaining!"

"Because I think I was in love with you Catra. And that terrified me more than anything."

"You were in love with me?"

"Yeah, I was. And I'm really sorry if that makes you uncomfortable, I didn't want it to ruin our relationship, and then my idiocy ruined it anyway. So I'm sorry, and--"

"You're an idiot," Catra interrupted, before climbing atop the still dripping wet Adora's lap, and framing her face with her hands. Adora stared up at her with the faintest bit of hope twinkling in her eyes.

Catra leaned down, and this time, unlike the last, Adora met her halfway. When they parted, they were both breathless. "I was in love with you too." Catra faintly whispered into her mouth.

A smile had graced the edges of Adora's mouth, though there was still a tinge of worry in it, "Can we start over, please? I've really missed you."

"I'm still mad at you, and I think I will be for a while. But yeah, we can start over. Just actually promise to talk to me this time?"

Adora beamed, "Yeah, I can do that."

Catra dove back in for another kiss, and found herself never wanting it to end.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!